Cognates packet

Words you already know: 487 Spanish-English cognates, from the Cognates tool. Print this packet and work on paper.

Name: _____ Date: _____

A **cognate** is a word that looks and means almost the same in Spanish and English, because both languages inherited it from Latin. That means you already know hundreds of Spanish words before your first lesson. There are three kinds: **perfect** cognates (the same word, like *animal*), **pattern** cognates (the same pattern with a small spelling change, like *información* / information), and **verb** cognates (like *abandonar* / to abandon). Learn to spot the patterns and your vocabulary doubles fast.

1. Match the perfect cognates

Write the letter of the English word next to each Spanish word. These are perfect cognates: words that look and mean almost the same in both languages.

1. actor
2. agenda
3. animal
4. área
5. aroma
6. artificial
7. atlas
8. bar
9. base
10. canal
11. capital
12. central

a. central
b. capital
c. canal
d. base
e. bar
f. atlas
g. artificial
h. aroma
i. area
j. animal
k. agenda
l. actor

2. Match the pattern cognates

Write the letter of the English word next to each Spanish word. These are pattern cognates: the same pattern with a small spelling change.

1. operación
2. producción
3. traducción
4. comunicación
5. organización
6. imaginación
7. condición
8. tradición

a. position
b. function
c. emotion
d. ambition
e. tradition
f. condition
g. imagination
h. organization

9. ambición
10. emoción
11. función
12. posición

i. communication
j. translation
k. production
l. operation

3. Sort them

Write **P** for a perfect cognate (same word), **Pa** for a pattern cognate (same pattern, small spelling change), or **V** for a verb cognate.

1. chocolate — write P, Pa, or V: _____
2. civil — write P, Pa, or V: _____
3. club — write P, Pa, or V: _____
4. color — write P, Pa, or V: _____
5. crisis — write P, Pa, or V: _____
6. criminal — write P, Pa, or V: _____
7. solución — write P, Pa, or V: _____
8. creación — write P, Pa, or V: _____
9. inspiración — write P, Pa, or V: _____
10. observación — write P, Pa, or V: _____
11. participación — write P, Pa, or V: _____
12. admirar — write P, Pa, or V: _____
13. admitir — write P, Pa, or V: _____
14. adoptar — write P, Pa, or V: _____
15. adorar — write P, Pa, or V: _____
16. afirmar — write P, Pa, or V: _____

4. Write the English

Write the English meaning of each Spanish cognate.

1. presentación: _____
2. protección: _____
3. universidad: _____
4. comunidad: _____
5. posibilidad: _____
6. oportunidad: _____
7. actividad: _____
8. realidad: _____
9. sociedad: _____

10. calidad: _____

11. curiosidad: _____

12. electricidad: _____

5. Write the Spanish

Write the Spanish cognate for each English word.

1. to analyze: _____

2. to announce: _____

3. to anticipate: _____

4. to applaud: _____

5. to apply: _____

6. to appreciate: _____

7. to argue: _____

8. to arrest: _____

9. to articulate: _____

10. to associate: _____

11. to assume: _____

12. to attack: _____

6. Use the pattern

English words ending in *-tion* usually become Spanish words ending in *-ción*. Write the Spanish form of each English word.

1. information: _____

2. station: _____

3. education: _____

4. nation: _____

5. action: _____

6. attention: _____

7. description: _____

8. celebration: _____

9. conversation: _____

10. invitation: _____

7. More patterns

Two more patterns do a lot of work. English adverbs ending in *-ly* usually become Spanish adverbs ending in *-mente*, and English nouns ending in *-ty* usually become Spanish nouns ending in *-dad*. Write the Spanish form of each English word.

1. finally: _____
2. probably: _____
3. directly: _____
4. quickly: _____
5. carefully: _____
6. easily: _____
7. exactly: _____
8. generally: _____
9. honestly: _____
10. immediately: _____
11. university: _____
12. community: _____
13. possibility: _____
14. opportunity: _____
15. activity: _____
16. reality: _____
17. society: _____
18. quality: _____
19. curiosity: _____
20. electricity: _____

8. Review quiz

Ten quick translations, mixed in both directions. No word bank this time.

1. cultural (Spanish) -> English: _____
2. identidad (Spanish) -> English: _____
3. to attract (English) -> Spanish: _____
4. digital (Spanish) -> English: _____
5. necesidad (Spanish) -> English: _____
6. to authorize (English) -> Spanish: _____
7. diploma (Spanish) -> English: _____
8. personalidad (Spanish) -> English: _____
9. to advance (English) -> Spanish: _____
10. director (Spanish) -> English: _____

9. Reflection

Answer in English or Spanish.

1. Which kind of cognate is easiest for you — perfect, pattern, or verb — and why?

2. Find three cognates in something you read this week (a book, a sign, a screen) and write them here with their meanings.

3. Write two sentences in Spanish, each using a different cognate from this packet.

Answer key (teachers): packet-cognates-answers.pdf